Fertilizer Spreader



Category: **Agriculture & Gardening** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 3 labs

Covers these lab items: A compact spreader; Manual fertilizer broadcaster

What it is used for

To distribute granular fertilizer evenly over a designated area using a manual fertilizer spreader. To apply the correct quantity while minimizing waste, drift, and uneven crop growth.

Main parts

- Fertilizer hopper or container
- Flow control gate or adjustment dial
- Spreading outlet or disc, depending on design
- Handle or frame
- Wheels or carrying straps, if fitted

Before you start

1. Read the fertilizer label and confirm the required application rate.
2. Choose a spreader suitable for the fertilizer granule size and area.
3. Inspect the hopper, flow control, outlet, and moving parts for damage or blockage.
4. Wear gloves, eye protection, and other PPE specified by the fertilizer label.
5. Check wind and weather conditions and keep people and animals away from the application area.

How to use

1. Calibrate the spreader according to the product rate and equipment instructions.
2. Fill the hopper in a well-ventilated area without overfilling.
3. Set the flow control to the calibrated position.
4. Start at the edge of the treatment area and maintain a steady walking pace.
5. Operate the spreader evenly, following the planned path and overlap pattern.
6. Avoid spreading near drains, open water, or areas not approved for treatment.
7. Close the flow gate before stopping or turning where appropriate.
8. Clean the spreader and wash hands after application.

⚠ Safety

- Follow fertilizer label directions and local environmental requirements.
- Avoid breathing fertilizer dust and prevent contact with eyes or skin.
- Do not spread during strong winds or heavy rain.
- Keep fertilizer away from food, drinking water, children, and animals.

Care & storage

- Empty unused fertilizer after use according to the label instructions.
- Clean the hopper and outlet to prevent corrosion or blockages.
- Dry metal parts before storage.
- Inspect wheels, controls, and fasteners regularly.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Applying fertilizer without calibrating the spreader.
- Using an incorrect flow setting or walking speed.
- Overlapping passes excessively or leaving untreated gaps.
- Allowing fertilizer to enter drains or waterways.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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